

WEEK 6 – PRINCIPLES OF GOOD DATA COLLECTION

DATA COLLECTION

- Data collection is the process of gathering information needed to answer research questions or meet the objectives of a study.

PRINCIPLES OF GOOD DATA COLLECTION

- **Relevance** – Collect only the data that is necessary to meet the objectives of the study. Avoid unnecessary or irrelevant data to save time and resources.
- **Accuracy** – Data should be correct, free from errors, and reflect reality.
- Use reliable tools and trained personnel to gather precise information.
- **Consistency** – Use standardized procedures, instruments, and definitions. Data should be collected in the same way across all participants and time periods.
- **Validity** – The data collected should truly measure what it is intended to measure. Ensure that the tools or questions used are appropriate for the target concept.
- **Reliability** – The method of data collection should produce stable and consistent results over time and across researchers.
- **Timeliness** – Data should be collected and available within a timeframe that allows it to be useful. Outdated data may not reflect current conditions or behavior.
- **Confidentiality** – Respect the privacy of participants. Data should be handled securely and only used for its intended purpose.

- **Objectivity** – Data should be collected impartially, without bias from the collector or respondent. Avoid influencing responses during interviews or surveys.
- **Ethical Consideration** – Obtain informed consent from participants. Avoid deception and protect vulnerable populations.
- **Cost-effectiveness** – Choose data collection methods that provide quality results without unnecessary expenses.

GOOD DATA COLLECTION PRACTICES

- Good data collection practices ensure accuracy, reliability, validity, and ethics in data gathering.
- Important practices include collecting relevant data, using accurate and reliable tools, applying consistent procedures, protecting confidentiality, maintaining objectivity, obtaining informed consent, and using cost-effective methods.

POOR DATA COLLECTION PRACTICES

- Poor data collection practices lead to inaccurate, biased, or unethical data.
- Important problems include collecting irrelevant information, using inaccurate instruments, inconsistent procedures, biased collection, failure to protect participant information, and failure to follow ethical considerations.

WEEK 7 – DATA PRESENTATION AND DESCRIPTIVE STATISTICS

DATA PRESENTATION

- Data presentation refers to the visual or tabular display of data to make it easier to understand.

COMMON FORMS OF DATA PRESENTATION

Table – Presents data in rows and columns for organized viewing and comparison.

Bar Graph – Uses rectangular bars to compare quantities or categories.

Pie Chart – Uses sections of a circle to represent proportions or percentages of a whole.

Line Graph – Uses points connected by lines to show changes or trends, commonly over time.

Scatter Plot – Uses points to show the relationship or possible correlation between two variables.

DESCRIPTIVE STATISTICS

- Descriptive Statistics is a branch of statistics that focuses on summarizing, organizing, and presenting data in an informative way.
- It is used to describe the basic features of data in a study and provides simple summaries about the sample and the measures.

MAIN TYPES OF DESCRIPTIVE STATISTICS

- Measures of Central Tendency – Describe where the center of the data lies.

MEAN

- The mean is the sum of all values divided by the number of values.

Formula: $\text{Mean} = \frac{\text{Sum of all values}}{\text{Number of values}}$

Example: 12, 15, 10, 13, 20

Sum = $12 + 15 + 10 + 13 + 20 = 70$

Number of values = 5

Mean = $70 \div 5 = 14$

MEDIAN

- The median is the middle value of a set of numbers when they are arranged in order.

Steps to find the median:

- Arrange the numbers from lowest to highest.
- If the number of values is odd, the median is the middle number.
- If the number of values is even, the median is the average of the two middle numbers.

MODE

- The mode is the number that appears most frequently in a set of numbers.

Steps to find the mode:

- List all the numbers.
- Count how many times each number appears.
- The number that appears most often is the mode.

Example: 12, 15, 10, 13, 20, 12

12 appears the most.

Mode = 12

MEASURES OF DISPERSION / VARIABILITY

- Measures of Dispersion describe how spread out the data is.

Range – The difference between the highest and lowest values.

Variance – The average of the squared differences from the mean.

Standard Deviation – The square root of the variance; shows how much values deviate from the mean.

RANGE

Formula: $\text{Range} = \text{Highest Value} - \text{Lowest Value}$

Example: Scores = 8, 10, 6, 9, 7

Highest = 10

Lowest = 6

Range = $10 - 6 = 4$

Variance and Standard Deviation Example:

Scores = 8, 10, 6, 9, 7

Sample Variance = 2.5

Sample Standard Deviation ≈ 1.58

MEASURES OF POSITION

- Measures of Position describe the location or relative position of a value within a data set.

Percentiles – Values below which a certain percent of the data falls.

Examples: 25th percentile, 50th percentile, 75th percentile.

Quartiles – Values that divide a data set into four equal parts when the data is arranged in ascending order.

FREQUENCY DISTRIBUTION

- A frequency distribution is a table that organizes data into categories or intervals and shows how often, or the frequency, each category or interval occurs.

Example: Test Scores of 20 Students

Raw scores: 45, 50, 55, 60, 65, 50, 55, 60, 45, 55, 65, 70, 60, 55, 50, 75, 70, 65, 55, 60

Interpretation:

Score 55 is the most common, with a highest frequency of 5.

Lowest score = 45.

Highest score = 75.

A frequency distribution provides a clear summary without listing all 20 scores.

WEEK 8 AND 9 – PROBABILITY CONCEPT

PROBABILITY

- Probability is the measure of how likely an event is to happen. It tells us the chance or possibility that something will occur.
- Probability is expressed as a number between 0 and 1, or 0% to 100%.

0 = The event is impossible.

1 = The event is certain.

Values between 0 and 1 show different levels of likelihood.

BASIC PROBABILITY FORMULA

- Probability of an Event = $\frac{\text{Number of Favorable Outcomes}}{\text{Total Number of Possible Outcomes}}$

Example – Rolling a Die:

Event E = Rolling a 4.

Total outcomes = $\{1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6\} = 6$ outcomes.

Favorable outcome = $\{4\} = 1$ outcome.

$P(E) = 1/6$

Example – Tossing a Coin:

Event E = Getting Heads.

Total outcomes = $\{\text{Head}, \text{Tail}\} = 2$ outcomes.

Favorable outcome = $\{\text{Head}\} = 1$ outcome.

$P(E) = 1/2$

BASIC PROBABILITY CONCEPTS

Experiment – A process that produces an outcome.

Examples: Rolling a die; tossing a coin.

Sample Space (S) – The set of all possible outcomes.

Example: Coin toss $\rightarrow S = \{\text{Heads}, \text{Tails}\}$

Event (E) – A subset of the sample space.

Example: Getting a Head $\rightarrow E = \{H\}$

Mutually Exclusive Events – Two events that cannot happen at the same time.

Example: Rolling a die and getting a 2 and getting a 5.

Independent Events – Two events where the outcome of one does not affect the other.

Example: Tossing two separate coins.

Complementary Events – Two events where if event A occurs, its complement A' does not occur.

$$P(A) + P(A') = 1$$

$P(A)$ = Probability of event A occurring.

$P(A')$ = Probability of event A not occurring, or its complement.

COMPLEMENTARY EVENTS EXAMPLE

Coin Toss:

A = Getting a Head.

A' = Getting a Tail.

$$P(A) + P(A') = 1.$$

Rolling a Fair Die:

A = Rolling an even number = {2, 4, 6}.

A' = Rolling an odd number = {1, 3, 5}.

RULES OF PROBABILITY

- Addition Rule
- Multiplication Rule
- Conditional Probability

ADDITION RULE

- The Addition Rule is used when finding the probability of either Event A OR Event B happening.

Mutually Exclusive Events – Events cannot happen at the same time.

$$P(A \text{ or } B) = P(A) + P(B)$$

Example: Rolling a die and getting either a 2 or a 5. Since both cannot occur at the same time, their probabilities are added.

Not Mutually Exclusive Events – Events can happen at the same time, so the overlap must be subtracted.

$$P(A \text{ or } B) = P(A) + P(B) - P(A \text{ and } B)$$

Example: Drawing a card from a deck.

MULTIPLICATION RULE

- The Multiplication Rule is used to find the probability that two events happen at the same time or in sequence.

INDEPENDENT EVENTS

- If events A and B are independent, the occurrence of one does not affect the other.

$$P(A \text{ and } B) = P(A) \times P(B)$$

Example: Tossing a coin and rolling a die.

CONDITIONAL PROBABILITY

- Conditional Probability is the probability of an event B happening, given that another event A has already happened.

$$\text{Formula: } P(B|A) = P(A \text{ and } B) \div P(A)$$

$P(B|A)$ = Probability of B given A.

$P(A \text{ and } B)$ = Probability of both A and B happening.

$P(A)$ = Probability of A happening.

Example – Students:

Find $P(\text{glasses} | \text{left-handed})$.

40 students total.

10 are left-handed.

6 of the left-handed students wear glasses.

14 total students wear glasses.

$$P(\text{glasses} | \text{left-handed}) = 6/10 = 0.60 = 60\%.$$

Meaning: If a student is left-handed, there is a 60% chance they wear glasses.

TYPES OF PROBABILITY

- Theoretical Probability
- Experimental Probability
- Subjective Probability
- Axiomatic Probability

THEORETICAL PROBABILITY

- Theoretical Probability is the likelihood of an event happening based on logic and known possible outcomes, without doing an actual experiment.
- It assumes that all outcomes are equally likely.

$$\text{Formula: Theoretical Probability} = \frac{\text{Favorable Outcomes}}{\text{Total Possible Outcomes}}$$

Examples:

Coin Toss → Probability of getting Heads = $1/2$.

Rolling a Die → Probability of getting a 3 = $\frac{1}{6}$.

EXPERIMENTAL PROBABILITY

- Experimental Probability is the likelihood of an event based on actual experiments, trials, or observations.
- It is calculated by performing an experiment and recording the outcomes.

Formula: Experimental Probability =
Number of Times the Event Occurs ÷ Total Number of Trials

Examples:

- A survey of 100 students shows 25 like Math best.
- A coin is tossed 20 times and Heads appears 12 times.

SUBJECTIVE PROBABILITY

- Subjective Probability is the likelihood of an event happening based on personal judgment, opinion, belief, or experience rather than exact calculation or experiments.
- It is often used when there is insufficient data or when the situation involves uncertainty.

Examples:

- A doctor estimates there is a 70% chance that a patient will recover based on medical experience.
- A student says, "I think there's a 90% chance I'll pass the exam," based on confidence and preparation.
- A sports fan predicts their team has a 60% chance of winning based on recent performance.

AXIOMATIC PROBABILITY

- Axiomatic Probability is a **formal and mathematical** approach to probability

introduced by Andrey Kolmogorov in the 1930s.

- It is based on axioms, or rules, that probability must always follow regardless of the experiment.

KOLMOGOROV'S THREE AXIOMS OF PROBABILITY

- **Non-Negativity** – The probability of any event is **never negative**.
- **Normalization / Certainty** – The probability of the sample space, containing all possible outcomes, is 1 or 100%.
- **Additivity** – If two events A and B are mutually exclusive, the probability of their union is the sum of their individual probabilities.

$$P(S) = 1$$

Example – Tossing a Coin:

Possible outcomes: Heads (H), Tails (T)

Sample Space: $S = \{H, T\}$

Because the coin is fair:

$$P(H) = 0.5$$

$$P(T) = 0.5$$

$$P(S) = P(H) + P(T) = 0.5 + 0.5 = 1$$

The total probability of all possible

outcomes together must equal 1 or 100%.

This means you are certain that when a fair coin is tossed, the outcome will be either Heads or Tails.

Example – Rolling a Die:

$$P(\text{rolling an even number}) = P(2) + P(4) +$$

$$P(6)$$

$$= \frac{1}{6} + \frac{1}{6} + \frac{1}{6}$$

$$= \frac{3}{6}$$

$$= 0.5$$